SpeechGeek



Season Eight: Winter 2011

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The Geek and Mrs. Geek have had a busy two months since the release of our Season Eight: Fall 2010 issue.

You see, we welcomed the newest forensicator to our family: Elliott. He may only be eight weeks old, but it seems that he already has the booming voice and screaming of a future Dramatic Interp all-star.

Based on the way I smile when I see him, maybe he'd be better suited for H.I. rounds?

Maybe he won't even like forensics--though I highly doubt that.

While every season is a new adventure, this one has been even more so around the SpeechGeek HQ. Becuase of our new addition, this second issue wraps Season Eight.

Don't worry, though, as there's still a lot of great stuff in store for you before Nationals 2011 in Dallas!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Hypothetically Yours

by Katie Newport

(Brian knocks on door, and Jeremy answers it.)

BRIAN. Hey, Jeremy.

JEREMY. Hey, Brian. Linda's not here right now... She should be back in maybe ten, fifteen minutes if you wanted to come back then.

BRIAN. *(lets himself in)* It's fine, I'll just wait here. I needed to talk to you, anyway.

JEREMY. *(closes door after a beat)* Sorry, but I'm actually kind of busy. I've got a lot of--

BRIAN. *(not paying attention)* Jeremy, can I ask you a question?

JEREMY. No.

BRIAN. Because I.... Wait. What?

JEREMY. No, you may not ask me a question.

BRIAN. But... Why not? I really need your help.

JEREMY. I'm sorry, but I cannot allow myself to "help" you again. You know what happened last time.

BRIAN. Oh, come on, Jeremy. We've known each other since high school, before I even started dating your sister. You can't let one little thing-

JEREMY. One little thing? That's a bit of an understatement, don't you think?

BRIAN. You're making this a bigger deal than it needs to be. I mean, that was so long ago that I can barely even remember what happened.

JEREMY. Oh? Let me take you back about two-and-a-half years ago. The location: this very living room.

BRIAN. Jeremy-

JEREMY. I was all dressed up, getting ready for a date. Then you suddenly burst through the door, begging for help and advice.

BRIAN. Are you done now?

JEREMY. *(ignoring him)* Jeremy! I need your help and advice! I want to take Linda to Hawaii for our five-year anniversary—did you know it's been five years since we started dating?--but I can't decide on the best mode of transportation and it is only four months away! Should I buy plane tickets or would a cruise be better?' Then we pro ceeded to go through what could hypothetically happen in each situation.

BRIAN. You can't possibly be blaming that on me.

JEREMY. Long story short, we ended up hypothetically stranded on a hypothetical island where, hypothetically, there was no food. This was, of course, after our hypothetical plane hypothetically crashed due to the hypothetical bird that flew into the hypothetical engine.

BRIAN. Jeremy! That was ages ago. And nothing that bad actually hap pened--

JEREMY. Brian, my date was ticked because I was late to pick her up.

Reggie Wilson...

by Christopher Rife

REGGIE. Hi, my name is Reggie. In my little town of Apple Valley, I'm pretty famous. See, I'm the most famous kid detective ever.

HARRIET. Don't forget about me! Harriet the Spy!

REGGIE. Shut up, Harriet! *(kicks her in the face)*

HARRIET. Ahhhh! I shall never sleuth again...

REGGIE. Anyway, I have my own business, solving such famous cases as *Who Stole the Cookies from the Cookie Jar* and *Do Chicken Pox REALLY Cause You to Turn into a Chicken*? Yes. Yes, they do. But little did I know that my biggest case was about to arrive. It was lunchtime...

FENTON. Reggie, Reggie!

REGGIE. That's Fenton. We've been best friends since kindergarten. *(to Fenton)* What seems to be the problem, buddy?

FENTON. I think Mr. Bailey is a robot. I mean, it totally makes sense! It's only the first day of fourth grade, and he already gave us homework over the weekend! He doesn't have a heart! And you know what else don't have hearts?

REGGIE. Grapes?

FENTON. Besides grapes! ROBOTS! And you know I have enough problems with my allergies as it is to go worrying about that robot killing me.

REGGIE. OK, I'll do it. I knew this was gonna be a tough case...I was gonna need some help. I needed animal instincts...like that kid in my class who was raised by wolves!

WOLF CHILD. Just because I was raised by wolves doesn't make me any different from you guys. *(starts scratching himself and howls)*

REGGIE. Maybe not. I needed someone with energy...like that kid with Restless Leg Syndrome!

RLS KID. I can't control it! *(legs shaking wildly)*

REGGIE. No. I needed someone with smarts. I needed a girl. I needed Susie!

SUSIE. Stop! You have reached the girls' lunch table—no boys allowed. You're not allowed to talk to me unless you talk in "girl."

REGGIE. Fine... Oh my Gosh, Susie, so here's the 4-1-1. We think Mr. Bailey is, like, a robot.

SUSIE. *(laughing)* You cannot be serious, girlfriend.

FENTON. We're so…so….so serious. Mr. Bailey shows no emotions. And what else shows no emotions?

SUSIE. Grapes.

FENTON. Besides grapes! …Robots!

SUSIE. I don't know, you guys. You have no evidence. Besides, what's in it for me?

REGGIE. *(to audience)* Looks like it was time to use my secret weapon. *(to Susie)* If you help us, I'll give you my Madame Curie trading card.

SUSIE. *(looking at the card with awe)* I've always wanted that one. It's the last card I need for the Famous Women Scientists set. Once I have that one, I'll have all three…OK, I'm in, whatever the price.

REGGIE. Great! Now, how do we get the evidence we need?

SUSIE. Assignment 1: Snooping in his classroom. I'm on it. Assignment 2: Eavesdrop on the teachers' lounge. That's where you guys come in. Assignment 3: *(beat)* There is no assignment three. Now scram.

REGGIE. Gotcha. C'mon, Fenton. Let's go.

(They sneak into the teacher's lounge.)

REGGIE. I pulled out my super high-tech listening device: a glass. *(puts it up to door)*

MR. BAILEY. Yes. Yes, dear. I need to stay home tonight. You know…recharge my batteries.

REGGIE. Fenton…Mr. Bailey has a battery pack. Like that percussionist rabbit!

FENTON. And remember that time when he asked me if I ate Slimy, the class snail? And I said "No." And he said he could see right through me? Only someone with eyes made out of technology could do that! I feel so violated.

SUSIE. Psssst. Reggie! Fenton!

REGGIE. Susie! Did you find anything?

SUSIE. You betcha, boys. I found these CDs on his desk: "Mr. Roboto," "Iron Man," *The Complete Works of Celine Dion*. And I found a piece of paper with his *FULL NAME* on it. Ulysses S. Bailey. His initials are U.S.B. Gentleman, we need to do something drastic.

REGGIE. We decided to go to someone who could do something about our problem. *(to Principal)* Principal Wilson! Principal Wilson!

PRINCIPAL. Yes, yes. Hold on. I need to send this email to fifteen friends so my crush will call me at midnight and profess their undying love to me. All…right… sent. Oh, hello, Reggie. Are you out solving another case?

REGGIE. Yes, sir. That's actually what we came here to talk to you about…

FENTON. MR. BAILEY IS A ROBOT! And we have proof! Mr. Bailey doesn't have any feelings! And what else doesn't have feelings?

PRINCIPAL. Grapes.

FENTON. *(extremely frustrated)* BESIDES GRAPES! *(exasperated)* ROBOTS! He's going to try to use me as a power source for all his diabolic plots. *(crying)*

PRINCIPAL. My goodness. If I hired a robot, I've put the children in serious danger…of being left behind! I need to do something about this!

(He picks up the phone and dials a humorously long number.)

PRINCIPAL. Doris? Would send in Bailey down to my office? Thank you. Alright, Bailey! Your secret is out!

MR. BAILEY. What secret?

PRINCIPAL. The children here have informed me that you, sir, are a robot. And if we have learned anything from the Salem Witch Trials, it's to always trust the accusations of small children!

FENTON. Yeah! *Domo arrigato*, Mr. Roboto!

REGGIE. And we heard you saying you needed to go home and "recharge your batteries!"

MR. BAILEY. Ha. Ha. Ha. Children, that's only a figure of speech.

FENTON. What about how you're speaking, huh?! Explain that!

MR. BAILEY. I have a speech impediment.

SUSIE. Oh my gosh. We are so…so….so….sorry. Gosh, it must really stink having a speech impediment.

PRINCIPAL. I feel awful. You know what? I'm going to give you a raise. Of course, I did just give half the school's budget to that very nice man in Nigeria, though. We'll just cut some more useless art classes from the budget.

SUSIE. C'mon Reggie, let's go. It's obvious Mr. Bailey is not a robot. We judged someone we didn't know unfairly. I think the moral here is pretty obvious.

REGGIE. I don't know, guys. Something still doesn't seem right… One last question, Bailey: What kind of movie is *The Terminator*?

MR. BAILEY. A tragedy due to the unjust persecution of robots.

REGGIE. A-ha!

MR. BAILEY. Darn.

REGGIE. OK, robot! What do you want with us!

MR. BAILEY. I only wanted to experience human love.

PRINCIPAL. …With little children?!

MR. BAILEY. Error. Syntax error. That's wrong. Very, very wrong.

REGGIE. Love? So you didn't wanna kill us?

MR. BAILEY. I am not programmed to kill. I have been working so hard to try and understand human emotion. It would be a shame to stop now. Is there any way I can stay?

PRINCIPAL. Hmm…If we keep a robot on staff, man alive, we'll become the first school in the nation to offer true robotic diversity! Think of the government grants! Alright, Bailey, you're back online!

MR. BAILEY. There is this burning sensation inside of me. What is this feeling?

REGGIE. Cafeteria food?

FENTON. Cooties ?

PRINCIPAL. Chlamydia, the adult cooties?

SUSIE. No, you guys. It's love! Mr. Bailey, you're experiencing love!

MR. BAILEY. Love. Mission accomplished. Thank you, children.

REGGIE. *(to audience)* Well, there you have it. Mr. Bailey still teaches at Apple Valley Elementary, but now he's teaching English.

MR. BAILEY. "And so the Velveteen Rabbit was taken away from the boy, and they never saw each other again." Tear.

REGGIE. The government grants let our school bring back the art and music classes.

FENTON. How did I not know about the wonders of the recorder?! *(plays "Hot Crossed Buns")*

REGGIE. And Fenton and I are still out solving cases. We even let Susie help us every once in awhile. She's a pretty good detective…for a girl. Luckily for us, there's never a shortage of mysteries in Apple Valley.

RLS KID. *(legs still shaking wildly)* HOW DO I MAKE IT STOP?

REGGIE. I'm on the case.